

ANGEL ACTION · BITES & STINGS

Jellyfish and Marine Stings

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Tropical jellyfish (box jellyfish, Irukandji)

Anywhere north of Bundaberg, treat any jellyfish sting as potentially life-threatening.

1. **Call 000.**
2. Pour **vinegar** liberally over the sting for at least 30 seconds.
3. If no vinegar, pick off tentacles (they will not sting through gloved fingers; bare fingertips are usually OK briefly).
4. Be ready to start **CPR** — box jellyfish stings can cause cardiac arrest.

Bluebottle and other non-tropical jellyfish

1. Wash the area with seawater (not fresh water) to remove tentacles.
2. Do **not** use vinegar.
3. Immerse the area in **hot water** (no hotter than the rescuer can tolerate) for 20 minutes. A hot shower works.
4. If hot water is not available, use a cold pack for pain.

Stingray, stonefish, cone shell

Immerse the limb in **hot water** for up to 90 minutes. Call **000** — these stings can be fatal.

Blue-ringed octopus

Apply pressure immobilisation (as for **snake bite**) and call **000**. Be ready for CPR — the venom paralyses breathing muscles.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*